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gayathri@Gayathri: ~/mini_st  ×  +  ▾
gayathri@Gayathri:~$ mkdir mini_shell
cd mini_shell
gayathri@Gayathri:~/mini_shell$ gedit shell.c

** (gedit:465): WARNING **: 09:46:41.450: Could not load Peas repository: Typelib file for namespace 'Peas', version '1.0' not found
** (gedit:465): WARNING **: 09:46:41.450: Could not load PeasGtk repository: Typelib file for namespace 'PeasGtk', version '1.0' not found
gayathri@Gayathri:~/mini_shell$ nano shell.c
gayathri@Gayathri:~/mini_shell$ ls
shell.c
gayathri@Gayathri:~/mini_shell$ cat shell.c
#include <stdio.h>
#include <stdlib.h>
#include <string.h>
#include <unistd.h>
#include <termios.h>
#include <sys/wait.h>

#define INITIAL_BUFFER_SIZE 64

/* History linked-list node */
struct Node
{
    char *command;
    struct Node *next;
};

/* Head and tail of history */
struct Node *history_head = NULL;
struct Node *history_tail = NULL;

/* Original terminal settings */
struct termios original_terminal;

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struct Node *history_tail = NULL;

/* Original terminal settings */
struct termios original_terminal;

/* Enable raw mode */
void enable_raw_mode()
{
    struct termios raw;

    tcgetattr(STDIN_FILENO, &original_terminal);

    raw = original_terminal;

    raw.c_lflag &= ~(ICANON | ECHO);

    tcsetattr(STDIN_FILENO, TCSAFLUSH, &raw);
}

/* Restore normal terminal mode */
void disable_raw_mode()
{
    tcsetattr(STDIN_FILENO, TCSAFLUSH, &original_terminal);
}

/* Add command to history */
void add_history(const char *command)
{
    if (command == NULL || strlen(command) == 0)
        return;

    struct Node *new_node = malloc(sizeof(struct Node));

    if (new_node == NULL)
    {

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    return;
}

new_node->command = strdup(command);

if (new_node->command == NULL)
{
    perror("strdup");
    free(new_node);
    return;
}

new_node->next = NULL;

if (history_head == NULL)
{
    history_head = new_node;
    history_tail = new_node;
}
else
{
    history_tail->next = new_node;
    history_tail = new_node;
}
}

/* Count history entries */
int history_count()
{
    int count = 0;
    struct Node *current = history_head;

    while (current != NULL)
    {
        count++;
    }
}

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{
    count++;
    current = current->next;
}

return count;
}

/* Get command at a particular history position */
char *get_history_command(int position)
{
    struct Node *current = history_head;
    int index = 0;

    while (current != NULL)
    {
        if (index == position)
            return current->command;

        index++;
        current = current->next;
    }

    return NULL;
}

/* Free entire history linked list */
void free_history()
{
    struct Node *current = history_head;

    while (current != NULL)
    {
        struct Node *next = current->next;
    }
}

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    struct Node *next = current->next;

    free(current->command);
    free(current);

    current = next;
}

history_head = NULL;
history_tail = NULL;
}

/* Clear current line */
void clear_current_line()
{
    printf("\r\033[K$ ");
    fflush(stdout);
}

/* Read a command with arrow-key history */
char *read_command()
{
    size_t buffer_size = INITIAL_BUFFER_SIZE;
    size_t length = 0;

    char *buffer = malloc(buffer_size);

    if (buffer == NULL)
    {
        perror("malloc");
        exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
    }

    buffer[0] = '\0';
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int history_position = total_history;

printf("$ ");
fflush(stdout);

while (1)
{
    char c;

    if (read(STDIN_FILENO, &c, 1) != 1)
        continue;

    /* ENTER */
    if (c == '\n' || c == '\r')
    {
        printf("\n");
        buffer[length] = '\0';
        return buffer;
    }

    /* BACKSPACE */
    if (c == 127 || c == 8)
    {
        if (length > 0)
        {
            length--;
            buffer[length] = '\0';

            printf("\b \b");
            fflush(stdout);
        }

        continue;
    }
}
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}

/* ESCAPE SEQUENCE */
if (c == '\033')
{
    char sequence[2];

    if (read(STDIN_FILENO, &sequence[0], 1) != 1)
        continue;

    if (read(STDIN_FILENO, &sequence[1], 1) != 1)
        continue;

    /* UP ARROW: ESC [ A */
    if (sequence[0] == '[' && sequence[1] == 'A')
    {
        if (history_position > 0)
        {
            history_position--;

            char *old_command =
                get_history_command(history_position);

            if (old_command != NULL)
            {
                length = strlen(old_command);

                while (length + 1 >= buffer_size)
                {
                    buffer_size *= 2;

                    char *temp =
                        realloc(buffer, buffer_size);

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                free(buffer);
                perror("realloc");
                exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
            }

            buffer = temp;
        }

        strcpy(buffer, old_command);

        clear_current_line();

        printf("%s", buffer);
        fflush(stdout);
    }
}

continue;
}

/* DOWN ARROW: ESC [ B */
if (sequence[0] == '[' && sequence[1] == 'B')
{
    if (history_position < total_history - 1)
    {
        history_position++;

        char *next_command =
            get_history_command(history_position);

        if (next_command != NULL)
        {
            length = strlen(next_command);

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        free(buffer);
        perror("realloc");
        exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
    }

    buffer = temp;
}

strcpy(buffer, old_command);

clear_current_line();

printf("%s", buffer);
fflush(stdout);
}
}

continue;
}

/* DOWN ARROW: ESC [ B */
if (sequence[0] == '[' && sequence[1] == 'B')
{
    if (history_position < total_history - 1)
    {
        history_position++;

        char *next_command =
            get_history_command(history_position);

        if (next_command != NULL)
        {
            length = strlen(next_command);

            while (length + 1 >= buffer_size)

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        buffer_size *= 2;

        char *temp =
            realloc(buffer, buffer_size);

        if (temp == NULL)
        {
            free(buffer);
            perror("realloc");
            exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
        }

        buffer = temp;
    }

    strcpy(buffer, next_command);

    clear_current_line();

    printf("%s", buffer);
    fflush(stdout);
}
}
else
{
    history_position = total_history;
    length = 0;
    buffer[0] = '\0';

    clear_current_line();
    fflush(stdout);
}

continue;
}

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/* Normal character */
if (c >= 32 && c <= 126)
{
    /* Resize buffer when necessary */
    if (length + 1 >= buffer_size)
    {
        buffer_size *= 2;

        char *temp =
            realloc(buffer, buffer_size);

        if (temp == NULL)
        {
            free(buffer);
            perror("realloc");
            exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
        }

        buffer = temp;
    }

    buffer[length] = c;
    length++;

    buffer[length] = '\0';

    putchar(c);
    fflush(stdout);
}
}

/* Execute command */
void execute_command(char *command)
{

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    return;

    /* Exit command */
    if (strcmp(command, "exit") == 0)
    {
        disable_raw_mode();
        free_history();
        exit(0);
    }

    /* History command */
    if (strcmp(command, "history") == 0)
    {
        struct Node *current = history_head;
        int number = 1;

        while (current != NULL)
        {
            printf("%d %s\n", number, current->command);

            number++;
            current = current->next;
        }

        return;
    }

    /* Create a copy because strtok modifies the string */
    char *command_copy = strdup(command);

    if (command_copy == NULL)
    {
        perror("strdup");
        return;
    }

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char *args[100];
int argument_count = 0;

char *token = strtok(command_copy, " ");

while (token != NULL && argument_count < 99)
{
    args[argument_count] = token;
    argument_count++;

    token = strtok(NULL, " ");
}

args[argument_count] = NULL;

if (argument_count == 0)
{
    free(command_copy);
    return;
}

pid_t pid = fork();

if (pid < 0)
{
    perror("fork");
}
else if (pid == 0)
{
    execvp(args[0], args);

    perror("execvp");
    exit(EXIT_FAILURE);
}
else
```

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    free(command_copy);
}

int main()
{
    enable_raw_mode();

    while (1)
    {
        char *command = read_command();

        if (strlen(command) > 0)
        {
            add_history(command);
            execute_command(command);
        }

        free(command);
    }

    disable_raw_mode();
    free_history();

    return 0;
}

gayathri@Gayathri:~/mini_shell$ gcc -g shell.c -o shell
gayathri@Gayathri:~/mini_shell$ ./shell
$ ls
shell  shell.c
$ pwd
/home/gayathri/mini_shell
$ ls
shell  shell.c
$ date
Sat Aug 29 09:49:25 UTC 2026
```

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shell  shell.c
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$ ls
shell  shell.c
$ date
Sat Aug 29 09:49:25 UTC 2026
$ whoami
gayathri
$ history
1  ls
2  pwd
3  ls
4  date
5  whoami
6  history
$ ./shell
$ echo This is a very long command used to test whether the dynamically allocated input buffer can resize correctly without causing a
buffer overflow
This is a very long command used to test whether the dynamically allocated input buffer can resize correctly without causing a buffer
overflow
$ pwd
/home/gayathri/mini_shell
$ date
Sat Aug 29 09:51:24 UTC 2026
$ history
1  echo This is a very long command used to test whether the dynamically allocated input buffer can resize correctly without causing
a buffer overflow
2  pwd
3  date
4  history
$ |
```

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a buffer overflow
2  pwd
3  date
4  history
$ exit
```